

THE VIEW FROM IRAN



FROM SACRED RULE TO STATE

Ayatollah Khamenei's Iran Today

DR ABDUL MAJID HAKEEM ILAHI

Representative of Iran's Supreme Leader

The representative of Iran's Supreme Leader in India, Dr Abdul Majid Hakeem Ilahi said the late Ayatollah Ali Khamenei attained "martyrdom", and defended the political transition to the new leadership. Speaking at the India Today conclave, he also emphasised Iran's civilisational ties with India and asserted, "Tehran does not seek war".

Ilahi added that the late leader had deliberately refused enhanced personal security—a secret location or a bunker—despite the risk to his life. "He believed that if the people of Iran could not have safe shelters, he should not have special protection for himself," Ilahi said, framing this as part of a philosophy of equality between leadership and citizens. Ilahi placed Khamenei's death within the Shia concept of martyrdom in the path of God—the highest form of sacrifice. He highlighted Khamenei's enduring interest in India and admiration for its pluralist society. Describing the new Supreme Leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, as an "intellectual and philosophical thinker" Ilahi said he lived just as simply as his father. Rejecting criticism that his elevation resembles hereditary succession, Ilahi emphasised that he was chosen by an elected Assembly of Experts for his "experience, knowledge and purity".

While defending Iran's actions in the ongoing conflict, Ilahi said Tehran was attacked by others and was acting in self-defence. He stressed that Islam places a high value on the sanctity of human life, except that Iran needed to defend its people and thus attacked regional US bases. ■

> **The goal of the late Ali Khamenei was unity among Muslims. He also praised India lavishly**

> **Mojtaba Khamenei is an intellectual and philosophical thinker who lives as simply as his father**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **The late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who refused special protection, craved martyrdom, and achieved it in the holy month of Ramadan. It is a sacrifice for faith and people**
- **Tehran did not want such a war. It was attacked and forced to respond to defend its people. Islam prohibits the harming of innocent people**
- **Protests in western countries is evidence that the conflict in West Asia has generated international criticism of Israel and the United States**

Photographs by BANDEEP SINGH